ACTIVITY 039

Word Stress Compass

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / A short unfamiliar text.

Make the natural stress of a lyric audible.

Lead toward the meaning



We sing **together** today

Keep the words around it clear

Keep the surrounding words clear; a meaningful word is not a shouted word.

1. Read the line as ordinary speech and circle its important syllables.
2. Speak it in the musical rhythm, keeping weak syllables clear but lighter.
3. Sing the line and compare whether listeners still hear its natural meaning.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The sung stress supports meaning rather than emphasizing every beat equally.

COMMON TRAP

Shouting the stressed word.

MAKE IT WORK

Clap the stressed syllables before adding all the words.